



Windows Messenger

Prevent Windows Messenger from running

 You installed MSN Messenger, and you now want to uninstall Windows Messenger. The standard method for uninstalling Windows Messenger often do not work, but you can prevent it from running at all. In the Run menu, type in "gpedit.msc." In the window that appears, look in the right pane—you'll see "Computer Configuration" and "User configuration." Click on "Computer Configuration," then on "Administrative Templates," then on "Windows Components," and finally on "Windows Messenger." Right-click "Do not allow Windows Messenger to be run," and choose "Properties." Choose the "Enabled" radio button. Do the same for "Do not automatically start Windows Messenger initially."

Change The Background

 You can change the background image in Windows Messenger. Click Run and type in "regedit", then navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\MessengerService. Double-click the InstallationDirectory value to verify the location of your Windows Messenger installation. By default, this location is C:\Program Files\Messenger.

Create the background image you want to use. Save the image you created as a .gif file named lvback.gif, and place the file in the Windows Messenger folder.

Exit the regedit, and restart Windows Messenger for the change to take effect. Depending on how large the picture is, it will occupy part of the messenger window. For example, if it is 640 x 480 pixels large, and you have dragged your Windows Messenger window to be around 200 x 200 pixels, only the lower left-hand corner of the picture will be displayed.

Change Sounds

 You can change the sounds you hear in Windows Messenger. Go to C:\Program Files\Messenger, and change the .wav files to any other .wav files. When you are changing them, remember to back up the old files first. Also remember their functions: 'online.wav' sounds when a buddy logs in; 'newemail.wav' is when you receive a new e-mail; and

careful to keep it short—you will be hearing a lot of it!

Change Font Colour

 Would you like your text to appear in a custom colour? Here is a plugin that allows you to choose, using sliders for red, green and blue, exactly what colour you want in your fonts: <http://members.home.nl/t.gorissen/custom%20msn%20colors.exe>.

Cool Stuff

 For animated smileys, interesting plugins, cool display pictures and the like, go to <http://www.mess.be/>

Emotise Your Nick

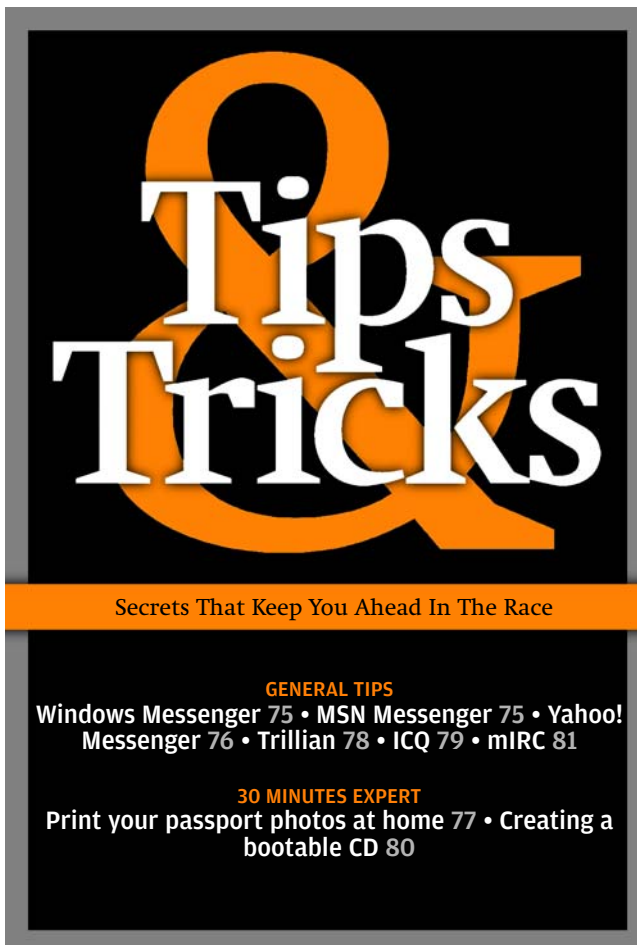
 You can add an emoticon to your nickname—the name that appears when other people receive messages from you. Go to Tools > Options, then in the 'Personal' tab, type in your name as you would like it to appear, along with the keyboard shortcut for the emoticon. For example, if you would like your name to appear as "Wolfhound" with a smiling face after it, simply type in "Wolfhound :)" here.

Two Instances Of Messenger

 Do you have two Hotmail (or MSN) accounts, and would like to make use of them by opening two MSN Messenger windows? You can do that by downloading a program, which is easy to install and creates a shortcut on the Start Menu. The download location is <http://members.home.nl/t.gorissen/several%20msn%20sessions.exe>

Clear Histories

 If some friends have signed into MSN Messenger using your computer, you might want to remove their histories. Go to Control Panel and select User Accounts. Click on your Windows XP user name, and go to Manage my network passwords. Here, you will find a list of the e-mail addresses that have been used to logon to Messenger. You can delete the ones you don't want.



'type.wav' is the sound you hear when you receive an instant message, so if you are changing this sound, be

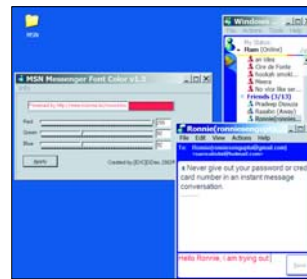


You can easily change the display picture in Windows Messenger

MSN Messenger

MSN Messenger: The Latest Version

 Download the latest version of MSN Messenger from here: <http://download.microsoft.com/>. Run the .exe file mentioned there to install Messenger. Alternatively, find the current latest version on the DVD accompanying this issue. You can also download the messenger from <http://download.com>.



Using Custom MSN Colors, you can change the colour of your font to any colour at all